

INTRODUCTORY PAPER



2020 ENGLISH

TIME ALLOWED: 35 MINUTES

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Bushwalk

Mum, Bonnie, Jack and little Benny are walking in the bush. Oh no! Benny has fallen over.



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What probably caused little Benny to fall over?

☐

He slipped on a rock.

☐

He went off the track.

☐

He tripped on a stick.

☐

He tripped over the red bag.

Bushwalk

Mum, Bonnie, Jack and little Benny are walking in the bush. Oh no! Benny has fallen over.



Text and images: © Janison Solutions Pty Limited

What is little Benny looking at?

☐

Bonnie and Jack

☐

Mum

☐

the track

☐

Mum's red bag

Bushwalk

Mum, Bonnie, Jack and little Benny are walking in the bush. Oh no! Benny has fallen over.



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How do we know little Benny is ok?

☐

Jack is cheering him up.

☐

He is getting up.

☐

Mum has helped him up.

☐

Bonnie has checked on him.

shake and make ice cream



What you will need:

- 1/2 cup milk
- 1 tablespoon sugar
- 1 tablespoon vanilla flavouring
- 1 small plastic bag with a seal
- 1 large plastic bag with a seal
- 1 tray of ice cubes
- 6 tablespoons rock salt
- 1 tea towel

How to make it:

Step 1

Put the milk, sugar and vanilla into the small bag. Squeeze out any extra air and seal.



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Step 2

Put the ice and salt in the large bag. Put the small bag inside the large bag. Seal the large bag really tightly. Shake the large bag until the mixture in the small bag looks like mashed potato. You can wrap a towel around the large bag if it gets too cold.



Step 3

Get the ice cream out of the small bag and eat it!



How does it work?

The salt makes the ice colder than usual so the mixture freezes more quickly.

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What do you put in the large bag first?

☐

milk and sugar

☐

sugar and vanilla

☐

vanilla and ice

☐

ice and salt

Shake the large bag until the mixture looks like _____.

What does the text say the ice cream will look like?

☐

mashed potato

☐

rock salt

☐

ice

☐

milk

Which section tells you why salt is used?

☐

What you will need:

☐

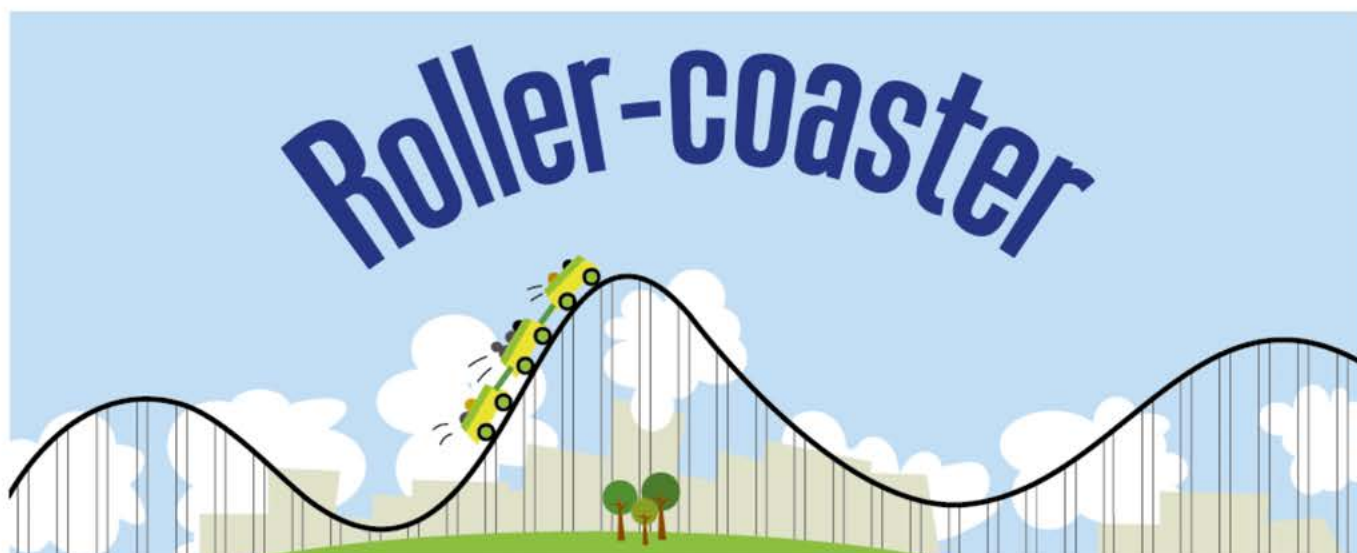
How to make it:

☐

Step 2

☐

How does it work?



We climb higher and higher and higher. Clickety-clack, clickety-clack. I use one hand to grip the bar holding me in place and the other to squeeze my sister Julie's hand. This is my first ride on a roller-coaster. The ride is pointing towards the sky. We reach the top. I think I can touch the clouds. Everyone stops talking. Everyone waits to go down the other side. Mum and Dad wave to us from the ground, looking so safe and small. They look like tiny toys. Dad shouts, 'Hold on, Damien!'

Then whoosh, zoom! Everyone is screaming. What was I thinking? My stomach does a loop-the-loop. Wind is slapping my face as we race down the first hill. I feel like I'm falling. No, I feel like I'm flying like a bird!

We roll up the next hill, the wheels squealing on the metal track. Julie looks at me, her eyes wide and shining. I start to giggle, then we whoosh down the hill. We twist and turn as the ride hurries around the tight corners. Julie and I bump into each other as we lean this way and that. Then we jolt to a stop. I can't believe the ride is over so soon. My head is wobbly, my knees are shaky, but my smile is huge.

'Do you want to go again, Julie?' I say, nudging her with my elbow.

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Why does everyone stop talking?

- ☐ They can't hear each other over the noise of the roller-coaster.
- ☐ They know the roller-coaster is about to go down the first hill.
- ☐ They are too busy waving to their families from the roller-coaster.
- ☐ They don't understand why the roller-coaster is not moving.

'We roll up the next hill, the wheels squealing on the metal track.'

Which underlined word from the sentence describes an action?

- ☐ 'next'
- ☐ 'wheels'
- ☐ 'squealing'
- ☐ 'track'

Which of these describes a sound in the text?

- ☐ 'whoosh' (paragraph 2)
- ☐ 'loop-the-loop' (paragraph 2)
- ☐ 'twist and turn' (paragraph 3)
- ☐ 'wobbly' (paragraph 3)

Which word is closest in meaning to 'hurries'?

- ☐ rushes
- ☐ glides
- ☐ crashes
- ☐ shakes

When Damien nudges Julie, it is a sign that he is

☐

bossy.

☐

grateful.

☐

annoyed.

☐

excited.



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Changing shoes



Most of us have different shoes for school, sports and special occasions. In the past, people didn't have these choices.

Early humans spent a lot of time in bare feet. That's right, no shoes! Imagine what that must have been like when the ground was hot from the sun or freezing from the snow. Ouch!

Humans needed something to protect their feet. So, they came up with the idea of making shoes out of vines, straw and other parts of plants. These shoes didn't last very long or give much protection from rain or snow. It was clear that better materials were needed. They tried animal skins and found that these lasted longer and were softer.

Long ago, humans in some areas with hot climates invented basic sandals. They simply had a sole and strap. However, you wouldn't want to be wearing these if you dropped a rock on your foot.

In cold climates, people preferred leather shoes, which enclosed the whole foot, to sandals. These shoes gave more protection and were warmer. For a long time, everyone wore the same type of simple leather shoes, whether they were a man, woman, boy or girl. There was also no difference between the left and right shoe. They were both straight so a shoe could be worn on any foot. Shoes didn't come in different sizes either, so it was bad luck if you had small feet and big shoes!

As time passed, shoes were created in various sizes and from a wider range of materials. Eventually, special shoes were made for different occasions, which made sense. Can you imagine wearing your sandals when you are skiing or your winter boots when you go to the beach?



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These 7000-year-old sandals from Spain are made from straw.

Text © Janison Solutions Pty Limited. Image: Sandal image by Luis García at the National Archaeological Museum of Spain.



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'That's right, no shoes!' (paragraph 2)

In this sentence, the writer expects readers to agree with her and

- ☐ be amazed.
- ☐ realise that it is not true.
- ☐ accept that it is a good idea.
- ☐ feel sad.

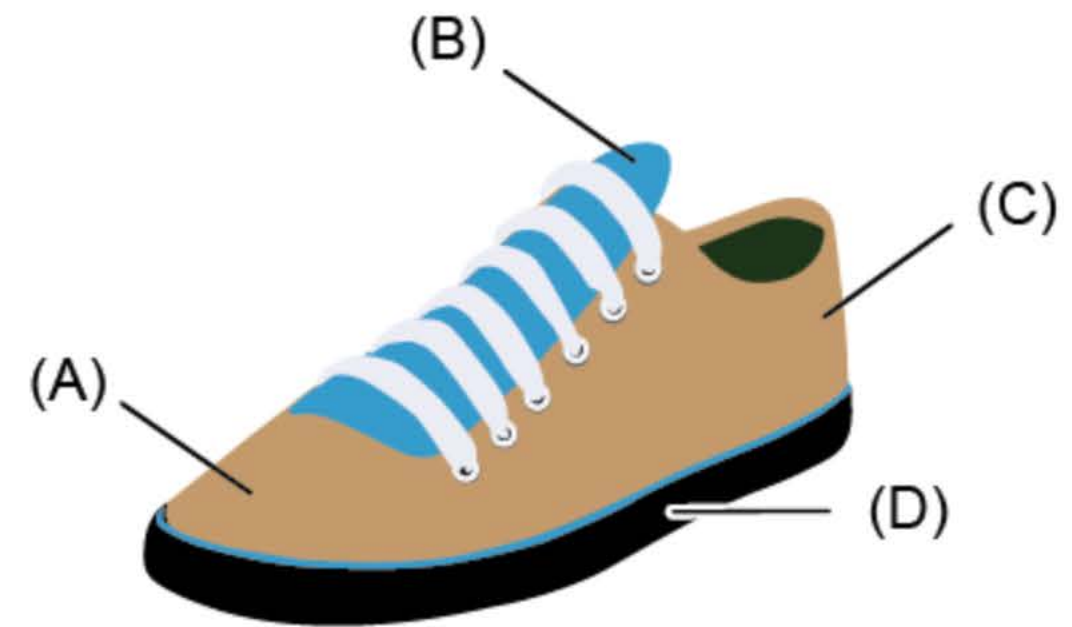
According to the text, shoes were invented so people could

- ☐ decorate their feet.
- ☐ live in cold places.
- ☐ protect their feet.
- ☐ move faster.

According to the text, shoes made from animal skins were better than those made from plants because

- ☐ they cost less money to make.
- ☐ they were soft and long-lasting.
- ☐ they came in different colours.
- ☐ they were easy to make and replace.

Which option shows the 'sole' of the shoe?



- ☐ A
- ☐ B
- ☐ C
- ☐ D

According to the text, how were the first leather shoes different from leather shoes today?

- ☐ They were smaller.
- ☐ They had one size.
- ☐ They were tougher.
- ☐ They had two straps.

What is the main purpose of this text?

- ☐ to explain how shoes are made
- ☐ to encourage readers to own lots of shoes
- ☐ to convince readers to wear the right shoes
- ☐ to give information about the history of shoes

RUIN



1 Pointing at the castle, Jamie made a face and said, 'Not another ruin! Look, it's broken and barely standing. Can't we do something else?'

2 Matilda shrugged, then grinned, her eyes shining. 'Come on, Jamie. Have a look with me. I'll be lonely by myself.'

3 Jamie's eyes darted between his sister's flushed face and his parents. Their faces were turned towards their phones, again. He huffed and said, 'Oh, ok then. But you owe me!'

4 Hiking up the track to the ruin, Jamie's and Matilda's shoes crunched on the rocky path. The walls soon loomed over them like giant shards of glass. Of course, no windows remained, only creeping green moss and vines. The children squeezed through a gap in a wall. The stones were crumbling but still gigantic. Jamie placed his forearm next to one and saw that the stone was wider. 'How did they carry them?' said Matilda, shaking her head in amazement.

5 Before Jamie could respond, a crackling, buzzing sound interrupted.

6 'Can you hear that?' Jamie asked Matilda.

7 'Hear what?' said Matilda, leaning toward Jamie.

8 Jamie touched the stone and the crackling boomed in his ears. Shutting his eyes, Jamie snatched his hand away from the stone. The crackling softened to a whirr and he could hear Matilda whispering his name. His face relaxed until he heard a clashing sound, like metal on metal. Could it be swords? No! Matilda must be playing a trick on him to try to keep his interest.



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- ‘Matilda! I know you’re up to something!’ he sang out. He opened his eyes, but Matilda wasn’t there. The ruin wasn’t there. The moss and vines had vanished. He stood near a castle wall. The stone he had touched was new, angular and not crumbly at all. The chatter of many voices filled his ears. Crouching behind a wall, Jamie turned towards the voices. He spied a market within the castle walls. He could smell baking bread. He could feel the rumble of horses’ hooves. Jamie scanned upwards, stone by stone, to the top of a tower with battlements and ... and guards!
- 10 Things were certainly getting very interesting.

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In the second paragraph, which sentence provides a reason?

- ☐ 'Matilda shrugged, then grinned, her eyes shining.'
- ☐ 'Come on, Jamie.'
- ☐ 'Have a look with me.'
- ☐ 'I'll be lonely by myself.'

In the third paragraph, Matilda's face is 'flushed' because she is feeling

- ☐ enthusiastic.
- ☐ embarrassed.
- ☐ hot and sweaty.
- ☐ worried.

‘Their faces were turned towards their phones, again.’

Which word shows Jamie is annoyed?

☐

‘faces’

☐

‘turned’

☐

‘phones’

☐

‘again’

‘Jamie placed his forearm next to one’

In the quotation, what does the word ‘one’ refer to?

☐

a gap in a wall

☐

a stone

☐

a pile of rubble

☐

a window

Why does Matilda's voice sound like a whisper to Jamie?

- ☐ He is being transported to another time.
- ☐ He isn't interested in what Matilda is saying.
- ☐ Matilda is playing a joke on him.
- ☐ He is too scared to concentrate properly.

In the second last paragraph, the writer uses the word 'spied' to imply that Jamie is

- ☐ interfering.
- ☐ staring.
- ☐ hiding.
- ☐ researching.

Here are some quotations from the second last paragraph: 'The stone he had touched', 'voices filled his ears', 'He could smell baking bread', 'He could feel the rumble'.

Why does the writer include these descriptions?

- ☐ to highlight the dangerous situation Jamie is in
- ☐ to show how real everything is to Jamie
- ☐ to illustrate how imaginative Jamie is
- ☐ to show how Jamie overreacts to problems

How does Jamie feel at the end of the text?

- ☐ curious
- ☐ delighted
- ☐ happy
- ☐ cheerful

Swinging flies



Have you ever wondered how a fly is able to land and walk on your ceiling? Is it magic? No, it's science. It was once believed that flies rolled in midair and turned themselves upside down to land—this is known as a barrel roll and it's a stunt that pilots do in planes—but it's not actually true. It wasn't until 1958 when *Natural History Magazine* printed photos of flies landing on a ceiling, that the truth was revealed.

When a fly is flying along and it gets close to the ceiling, it stretches out its two front legs above its head. It then grabs the ceiling with these legs. Because of its forward motion, the rest of the fly's body swings up. Its whole body makes contact with the ceiling. It tightens its grip on the ceiling with the rest of its legs.

But how does it stay there and move around? Each foot of the fly has two footpads. These pads, called *pulvilli*, have tiny hairs called *setae*. The *setae* increase the contact area between the fly's footpads and any surface, therefore increasing the attraction force (a force that pushes things together) between them. In 2006, scientists discovered that these *setae* actually produce a sticky glue-like substance made up of sugars and oil. It is this sticky liquid that a fly uses to hold onto the ceiling. But there's a problem. The sticky liquid needs to be strong enough to hold the fly onto the ceiling, but not so strong that the fly gets stuck upside down and cannot move.



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To solve this problem, each fly foot has a pair of claws to help pry the sticky foot off the ceiling. The fly uses a variety of techniques to do this including twisting, pushing and peeling. To walk on the ceiling, the fly has to use these techniques each time it moves. This takes a lot of energy. When the fly is on the ground, it uses much less energy because it only uses three of its six legs.

Now you have all the sticky proof you need to explain how flies walk on ceilings. But just keep in mind that the sticky liquid is the reason flies have such a bad reputation for spreading diseases. Whatever they land on—rubbish, poop—they carry a tiny bit with them to their next landing spot. And that might be your lunch!

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What does the word 'revealed' mean?

☐

made known

☐

proven in an experiment

☐

described in detail

☐

explained clearly

The words *setae* and *pulvilli* are written in italics to show that they are

☐

translated names.

☐

proper nouns.

☐

old-fashioned names.

☐

scientific names.

According to the text, which statement about flies is true?

- ☐ Flies have one footpad on each foot.
- ☐ Flies' feet are called *pulvilli*.
- ☐ The *setae* produce a glue-like material.
- ☐ Flies sometimes get stuck upside down.

The word 'pry' means that the fly is

- ☐ using its claws to scratch away the sticky liquid.
- ☐ using its claws to force its feet off the sticky liquid.
- ☐ holding on to the ceiling with the claws to pull its feet away from the sticky liquid.
- ☐ producing a substance from its claws to remove the sticky liquid.

What simple behaviour could flies adopt to save energy?

- ☐ turning in midair before landing
- ☐ landing on four legs rather than two
- ☐ walking only on the ground
- ☐ using only three legs when flying

Which **two** words are used as verbs in the text?

- ☐ 'ceiling' (paragraph 4)
- ☐ 'including' (paragraph 4)
- ☐ 'spreading' (paragraph 5)
- ☐ 'landing' (paragraph 5)

According to the text, why is the glue-like material bad for humans?

- ☐ It contains sugar and oil which attracts other insects.
- ☐ It is left behind by the fly and attracts dirt.
- ☐ It picks up disease-causing particles that the fly lands on.
- ☐ It is sticky and hard to clean.



The world's largest flower grows on a plant called *Rafflesia*. Each flower may grow up to one metre wide. It takes up to 10 months for a flower to _____ but it dies after a few days. The flower also gives off a strong _____ which some people say is like rotting meat. The plant is very _____ as it is only found in a few places in the world.

Choose the option that best completes the highlighted part of the text.

- ☐ age
- ☐ live
- ☐ open
- ☐ finish



The world's largest flower grows on a plant called *Rafflesia*. Each flower may grow up to one metre wide. It takes up to 10 months for a flower to _____ but it dies after a few days. The flower also gives off a strong _____ which some people say is like rotting meat. The plant is very _____ as it is only found in a few places in the world.

Choose the option that best completes the highlighted part of the text.

- ☐ taste
- ☐ smell
- ☐ colour
- ☐ sound



The world's largest flower grows on a plant called *Rafflesia*. Each flower may grow up to one metre wide. It takes up to 10 months for a flower to _____ but it dies after a few days. The flower also gives off a strong _____ which some people say is like rotting meat. The plant is very _____ as it is only found in a few places in the world.

Text © Janison Solutions Pty Limited. Image: Rafflesia Arnoldii image by ma_suska https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/File:Rafflesia_sumatra.jpg CC BY-SA 4.0

Choose the option that best completes the highlighted part of the text.

- ☐ rare
- ☐ ugly
- ☐ native
- ☐ strange

Results

Question number	Correct answer	Mark	Category	Descriptor
1	C	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Interpret the cause of an event in a visual text
2	B	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify what a character is looking at in a visual text
3	B	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Interpret a visual text to evaluate a situation
4	D	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Locate the ingredients needed in a specific step in a simple recipe
5	A	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify a comparison in a simple procedure
6	D	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify the subheading for a section in a simple procedure
7	B	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Interpret the reason for an action in a recount
8	C	☐ ☐	Syntax	Identify a verb in a recount
9	A	☐ ☐	Writer's craft	Identify an onomatopoeic word in a recount
10	A	☐ ☐	Vocabulary	Identify the meaning of a word in a recount: hurries
11	D	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Interpret a character's mood in a recount
12	A	☐ ☐	Writer's craft	Infer the writer's expectation from a sentence in an information text
13	C	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Locate a specific piece of information in an information text
14	B	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify a comparative detail in an information text
15	D	☐ ☐	Vocabulary	Identify the meaning of a word in an information text: sole
16	B	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Locate a key supporting detail in an information text
17	D	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Understand the main purpose of an information text
18	D	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify a sentence in a narrative which provides a reason
19	A	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Explain a character's facial expression in a narrative
20	D	☐ ☐	Writer's craft	Understand how language expresses emotion in a narrative
21	B	☐ ☐	Syntax	Identify a pronoun referent in a narrative
22	A	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Analyse the reason for an event in a narrative
23	C	☐ ☐	Writer's craft	Interpret the implications of a word in a narrative
24	B	☐ ☐	Writer's craft	Explain the purpose of sensory details in a narrative
25	A	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Infer a character's feelings at the end of a narrative
26	A	☐ ☐	Vocabulary	Interpret the meaning of a word in a factual text: revealed
27	D	☐ ☐	Syntax	Understand the use of italics in a factual text
28	C	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Evaluate information in a factual text to identify a correct statement
29	B	☐ ☐	Vocabulary	Interpret the meaning of a word from a factual text: pry
30	C	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Use information from a factual text to solve a problem

Results

Question number	Correct answer	Mark	Category	Descriptor
31	B, C	☐ ☐	Syntax	Identify 'ing' words that are verbs in a factual text
32	C	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Interpret a factual text to determine the cause of a problem
33	C	☐ ☐	Vocabulary	Interpret an information text to identify the word which best suits the context: open
34	B	☐ ☐	Vocabulary	Interpret an information text to identify the word which best suits the context: smell
35	A	☐ ☐	Vocabulary	Interpret an information text to identify the word which best suits the context: rare

You have completed this practice test.

Your mark is

0 / 35

0%

Click here to reset the test and try again.

